

Going Home with an Ear Infection

A guide for your pet's recovery at home

Your pet was diagnosed with an ear infection while in our care at the shelter and treatment was started. Any medications your pet received are listed in your adoption paperwork.

What to Expect

- Ear redness, discharge, odor, and discomfort should gradually improve over the next several days.
- If your pet received a **long-acting ear medication**, nothing needs to be put in the ears at home unless your adoption paperwork says otherwise.
- Ear infections may return, especially in pets with allergies or floppy ears.

Home Care

- Give all medications exactly as directed.
- Keep the ears clean and dry.
- Gently wipe away discharge from the ear flap with a soft cloth or cotton ball.
- **Do not** put cotton swabs, water, hydrogen peroxide, alcohol, or other ear products into the ears unless instructed by your veterinarian.
- Avoid swimming until the infection has resolved.

Contact Your Veterinarian If Your Pet Has:

- Worsening redness, swelling, pain, or discharge
- A foul odor that is getting worse
- Head shaking or scratching that does not improve
- Head tilt, loss of balance, or difficulty walking
- A swollen or puffy ear flap
- Crying or pulling away when the ear is touched

Follow-Up Care

Schedule a follow-up visit with your veterinarian within **2–4 weeks** after adoption, or sooner if the ear worsens.

Bring your adoption paperwork so your veterinarian knows which medications were given.